

Koda the Koala and the Sleepy Leaf

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



Koda was a fluffy gray koala. He lived in a tall eucalyptus tree. Every night, Koda sniffed a special leaf. It was soft and silvery. It smelled like sweet dreams. Sniff sniff. Then Koda would fall asleep. It was his bedtime habit. One evening, Koda reached for his leaf. It was gone! The wind had carried it away. Koda searched the branches. No leaf. He searched the fork of the tree. No leaf. Koda felt worried. His nose twitched. "I cannot sleep without my sleepy leaf," he said. He felt restless. He tossed and turned.



His friend Wattle the wombat lived at the tree's roots. Wombats are sturdy and kind. "Koda," called Wattle. "Why so wiggly up there?" "My sleepy leaf blew away," said Koda. "I need its smell to sleep." Wattle thought for a moment. "Maybe we can find its smell together," she said. "Breathe in, breathe out, sleep is near." "Breathe in, breathe out, sleep is near." Koda repeated it slowly. "Breathe in, breathe out, sleep is near." It became their bedtime breathing. "Breathe in, breathe out, sleep is near."



Wattle climbed halfway up the tree. She sniffed the bark. Sniff sniff. "This branch smells sleepy," she said. Koda sniffed it. Breathe in. It smelled a little sleepy. Wattle found a fresh gum leaf. Soft and silvery. "Try this one," she said. Koda held it to his nose. Breathe in. Sweet and calm. Breathe out. His eyes felt heavy. "It smells like sleep," whispered Koda. He felt calm. He felt drowsy. The new leaf worked like magic.



Can you breathe like Koda? Breathe in... smell the leaf. Breathe out... let your body soften. Again: breathe in, breathe out, sleep is near. Koda tucked the new leaf under his cheek. Wattle curled in the roots below. "Thank you for helping me," whispered Koda. "Goodnight, sleepy koala," said Wattle. Koda breathed in. Breathe in, breathe out, sleep is near. The tree swayed gently. The night birds sang softly. Koda's eyes closed. He was not worried anymore.



The moon peeked through the leaves. Koda's breathing grew slow and deep. Breathe in... breathe out. His new leaf smelled like sweet dreams. Wattle smiled up at him. "Sleep tight," she whispered. The stars twinkled above the treetops. The world was quiet and calm. And Koda slept the whole night through.

Moral: *A calm breath and a kind friend can bring the sleepest sleep.*

The End